

After the authentication, the PIN is needed to begin the transaction. It might be coded onto the card, or stored remotely by the bank's server.

So yeah, with the multi-step checking in place, the most probable reason you will lose money is if you lose your card – to a crook, or your wife, or children. No kidding. Identity thefts are really the overwhelming majority of all credit card frauds. And because you're feeding off borrowed money, there's theoretically no limit to the exact amount you can lose. Or spend. Which will eventually be bad either way. And knowing the amazing spectacle of speed that is Indian judiciary, we suggest you watch your back.

Debit cards

They are sort of the yin to credit cards' yang. Everything works almost exactly the same way, its just that here the provider is just a gateway, and all the money that you use is essentially what you own. Therefore, you are not relying on your future income to bail you out of the stuff that you're getting into now. The technical details being essentially same, the chances of fraud are also the same as credit cards. The plus-point



here is that because the spending is limited by the amount of money that you currently have in your connected account is the limiter on the order of the fraud that can be committed by misuse of the card. Still, with the huge perks on offer, debit cards being the lesser of all of the previous evils, we give it a more than fair shot here in India.

Now, there are another couple of methods that are all the rage.

Internet banking

Internet banking is basically passing the control of your account over to you. Every relevant detail of your money is laid bare in front of you. You can do most of whatever you do at a bank at this terminal, except maybe chatting up the receptionist. Your bank provides you with a login user id,